mentioned earlier in this chapter. When Tyler first looks at the marketplace, he is discouraged by the current listings, which are *very* bad deals with high price points—but at the end of his lease-end timeline, a *moderately* bad deal happens to appear. He swoops in, convinced it's a good deal, that his real estate agent is a genius, and that he got lucky the property came online right at the perfect moment. (And as we now know, this "perfect moment" is one that he unknowingly invented. Better luck next time, Tyler.)

PREPARE CALMLY TO ACT AGGRESSIVELY

You should be ready to pounce on a good deal—an actual good deal, based on previously sold homes—the second it comes on the market. However, this isn't a type of preparedness you can rush into. Remember, to buy your first home, you must:

- Be financially ready
- Have a reasonably long purchase timeline
- Define exactly what you want
- Know what a good deal looks like

Take your time to meet these requirements. Once you're 100 percent comfortable with all of them, it's time to hire a real estate agent and make an offer.

The idea is this: If you've seen five to ten properties that meet your criteria that have sold in the last three to six months, then you know that on average, a deal like this will hit the market every eighteen to thirty-six days. That's one or two deals per month.

In other words, you might have to wait patiently for two to three months for your winner to materialize—or it might hit tomorrow, so you need to be prepared now. You need to have your financing set up, and you need to have a real estate agent ready to go. You need to be notified when a property that meets your needs comes on the market, and you have to offer aggressively and quickly when it does.

Think of it like fly fishing—you could get a bite at any time, but you need to be in the water and constantly casting your line so you can react and set the hook as soon as you get a bite. If you don't act, you miss the fish. If